

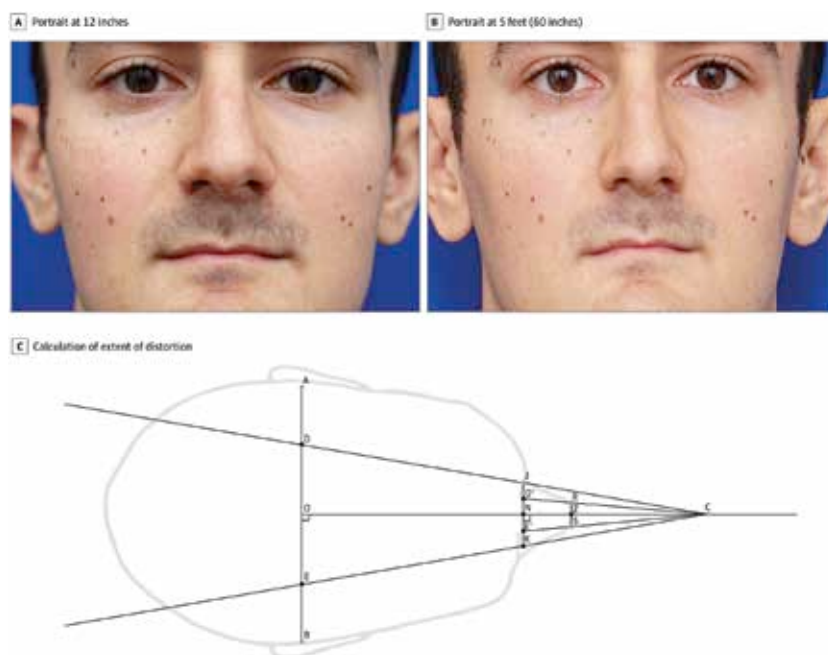
white balance on their phones were “correcting” everything to look normal. Some went as far as calling it AI censoring the apocalypse!

One totally unexpected security hole that arose from technology is the geolocation that’s inserted into images that we click by default thanks to our phones. This is a serious security concern, especially for a woman, as a simple selfie at home, or a picture of a birthday party celebration that’s uploaded on to a platform that does not remove location data means anyone with access to that photo now knows exactly where she lives! While this is no longer a problem for most social networks, remember this when you share images via email, or on a pen drive – such as when you send them off to a studio to get prints.

Another pet peeve from Team Digit is selfie cameras. We hate them. Selfie cameras are designed to take photos close up, yet still try to capture the background in order to offer background blurs like good portrait photography, and this means they end up doing a poor job of everything. A selfie camera captures images that are distorted, which means your face doesn’t actually look the way it does in selfies. Normally this shouldn’t be a big deal for people, however since so many of us measure our own self worth based on likes and comments in this digital age, there are actually people out there having plastic surgery just to look better in selfies! Even if you aren’t the type to take a knife to your face for a better selfie, the problem of thinking you have a big nose for example, when it’s the camera making your nose look wider, may result in a poor self image that damages your confidence. Want to know what you actually look like to other people? Get someone to click a picture using the regular rear lens of your phone (not the wide angle one). Better yet, stop caring, because we’re all just who we are.

VIDEO TECHNOLOGY

When it comes to video, there are multiple aspects that have been ruined by tech over the years. While home videos were primarily a way to



On the left is the extent of distortion on photos taken at close range, look at the nose area

document moments in our lives, now they’re things we have to do just to fit in, and that means almost none of it is real. A lot of this is because of the kind of content we see around us, and the peer pressure we feel to compete or fit in with the people who are creative, that we’re just documenting ridiculous things. The rise of Tik Tok and others like it, plus the way we want to make videos for social media in general results in everything being rather extreme. People have actually died, or been badly injured trying to make videos that would hopefully go viral, and all they got was a Darwin award instead.

It’s not just shooting videos but also the need to spruce them up with editing and effects, to the point where anything real and informative is considered super boring. Given that video is how the world is now consuming content, some of us at Team Digit are truly worried about where we’re headed as a society, if all that anyone sees is junk from TikTok!

Of course it’s not just the shooting of video that’s worse now, the sheer amount of bandwidth available to everyone coupled with cheap cameras everywhere means we’re literally inundated with video content on a regular basis. And boy is video addictive. While wasted time is one of the worst

side effects of all this video content out there, thanks to how easy it is to fall down a rabbit hole, it’s in no way the only way videos are disrupting life. The internet itself is straining under the load of video streaming, and boy do we feel it in crowded countries like ours. Binge watching content and on-demand video for anything we can think of searching for is also making us an impatient lot.

The most obvious problem with binge-watching a series or falling down a rabbit hole for half a day on YouTube is that you lose sleep, and suffer from eye strain. Those are just the obvious side effects which are the easiest to spot. What binge-watching also does is a lot like a hit of a drug, dopamine in our case, which the body releases. You get a happy feeling that makes you want more and more of the same, much like any addictive drug. The problem is, chasing dopamine highs usually ends up harming some other system of the body, which will come back to bite you after the dopamine high wears off. In some cases this can cause people to jump from the pleasurable highs of dopamine straight into depression or sadness, which is a terrible price to pay for some binge-watching. Plus, those of us who binge-watch things usually let some other activity in